Joe Karlsson

Principal Developer Marketing Manager

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I've spent 15 years making complex data systems click for developers - through talks, docs, demos, and content. I run full DevRel functions at data companies, with a track record in organic growth, developer activation, and pipeline influence.

EXPERIENCE

Principal Developer Marketing Manager

2026 – Present

CData · Remote

MCP · AI Agents · SQL · REST APIs · SEO · Python

- Lead developer marketing for CData's managed MCP platform - the layer that connects AI agents to live enterprise data - owning developer growth end to end
- Own the developer growth engine: technical docs, content, SEO and AEO, and how the platform gets positioned to the engineers actually building on it
- Grow the organic developer adoption already forming around Connect AI
- Partner with Product, Engineering, and Docs to keep the developer experience tight and make CData the obvious pick for wiring AI agents up to enterprise data
- Build the demos, guides, and content that show developers how to solve their actual problem instead of pitching at them

Head of Developer Relations

2024 – 2026

CloudQuery (now env0) · Remote

GCP · AWS · Azure · ClickHouse · Python · SQL

- Built the Developer Relations function from scratch - sole owner of content, community, docs, events, and video
- Rewrote docs end-to-end: Quickstart completions went from zero to 25/week, docs traffic grew 302%, and docs became a measurable activation channel
- Grew organic traffic 4x in under 3 months (~1,350 → 5,600+ visitors/week); two target keywords reached #1
- Monthly MQLs hit 239% of target; content became a measurable pipeline channel, with organic readers converting to trials and closed deals with no paid touchpoints
- Published 80+ technical posts across cloud security, IaC, and data engineering; ran a webinar series, YouTube channel, and spoke at conferences
- Embedded across Engineering, Product, and Sales - attended daily standups and merged 480+ PRs directly into production
- Replicated the content playbook at env0.com post-merger: +106% organic traffic in 3 weeks

Senior Developer Advocate

2023 – 2024

Tinybird · Remote

SQL · ClickHouse · BigQuery · Kafka · Snowflake · Redshift · Python · GCP · AWS

- Partnered closely with the Sales team on pre-sales support and customer demos - integrated with prospects' existing tech stacks to build tailored demos that showed exactly how Tinybird fit their architecture
- Built real-time technical integrations for demos and customer proof-of-concepts: fraud detection system on GCP/BigQuery/Kafka (33% reduction in fraudulent transactions); BigQuery IoT optimization for a trucking firm (40% compute cost reduction, 30% faster data retrieval)
- Produced technical content, videos, and webinars covering real-time analytics use cases for a developer audience
- Built community through workshops, online forums, and conference representation

Senior Developer Advocate

2021 – 2023

SingleStore · Remote

SQL · MySQL · Go · Node.js

- Led content and video production strategy for SingleStore's developer audience - technical tutorials, conference talks, and demos targeting developers migrating from MySQL and PostgreSQL

- Built co-marketing partnerships with cloud providers and tooling partners, coordinating joint content, webinars, and conference activations with their marketing and DevRel teams
- Planned and executed developer conference presence end-to-end: talk submissions, booth strategy, event logistics, and post-event content amplification
- Worked cross-functionally with Engineering, Documentation, and Sales to align content with product launches, maintain technical accuracy, and support pre-sales needs

Senior Developer Advocate

2019 – 2021

MongoDB · Remote

`JavaScript · Node.js · Python · React · MongoDB · AWS`

- Keynoted at MongoDB World and led global conference event strategy; when COVID hit, pivoted to lead MongoDB's digital growth strategy across Twitch, YouTube, and social - driving developer awareness and product adoption through an entirely new channel mix
- Built memorable technical demos to showcase MongoDB features in creative, engaging ways: IoT kitty litter box, IoT digital graffiti board, and dozens of other projects that drove community growth and product awareness
- Owned MongoDB's live stream and video production, building a 25K+ TikTok following; ranked #1 on "Must-Follow Developers on TikTok"
- Played a key role in defining and standardizing MongoDB developer best practices - authored canonical guides and videos on schema design, aggregation, and Atlas that became the reference point for the ecosystem; published across MongoDB Developer Hub, The New Stack, and Medium

Front End Technical Lead

2017 – 2019

Best Buy · Minneapolis, MN

`JavaScript · Node.js · React · Redux · Express · AWS`

- Led a cross-functional team of 10 engineers, QA, and product on one of the top 3 largest eCommerce sites in North America - a platform handling millions of users and thousands of requests per second
- Owned Account Home for bestbuy.com end-to-end: drove full redesign and implementation partnering closely with UX, product, and backend teams
- Engineered AI-driven chatbot using NLP and ML that reduced customer support call volume by 25%

Full-Stack JavaScript Instructor

2015 – 2017

DevLeague · Honolulu, HI

`ES6 · JavaScript · Node.js · React · Angular · PostgreSQL · AWS`

- Taught full-stack JavaScript at one of the top 10 coding bootcamps worldwide
- Developed curriculum, led workshops, and mentored students into engineering roles at local and national companies

SKILLS

LANGUAGES

JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Go, Rust, SQL

DATABASES

MongoDB, PostgreSQL, MySQL, ClickHouse, Redis, Elasticsearch, SingleStore

CLOUD & DATA

AWS, GCP, Azure, BigQuery, Snowflake, Kafka, Airflow

AI & AUTOMATION

LLM APIs, AI Workflow Automation, Prompt Engineering, AI-assisted Content Pipelines, Sales Enablement Automation

FRONTEND

React, Redux, Astro, Tailwind CSS, D3.js

DEVREL & MARKETING

Technical Writing, Conference Speaking, Content Strategy, SEO, Conversion Optimization, Sales Enablement, Marketing Analytics, Community, Webinars

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Arts in Computer Science

2008 – 2012

Gustavus Adolphus College

GPA: 3.5 · Minors: Art History, Math